

CUTANEOUS MANIFESTATIONS OF SEAFOOD INGESTION AND SEAFOOD POISONING

Dermatologic reactions may occur following the ingestion of seafood. **Urticaria, angioedema,** and, rarely, **leukocytoclastic vasculitis** can develop in individuals sensitized to fish or shellfish. Certain seafoods, such as kelp, are rich in iodine and may trigger **acneiform eruptions**.

Scombroid food poisoning results from consuming spoiled fish of the Scombroideae family—including tuna, mackerel, and bonito. When these fish are not adequately refrigerated after capture, bacterial decarboxylation of histidine produces **histamine, saurine,** and possibly other toxic compounds. Clinical features include prominent **erythema and flushing** of the face, neck, and upper trunk, along with **pruritus, urticarial eruptions,** and **angioedema**. Symptomatic treatment with **antihistamines** is effective, particularly in severe cases.

Ciguatera poisoning arises from ingestion of fish contaminated with ciguatoxin, a toxin produced during blooms of marine dinoflagellates (e.g., *Gambierdiscus toxicus*). The toxin bioaccumulates in predatory reef fish and is heat-stable, meaning it remains active even after cooking. Dermatologic manifestations include **generalized pruritus, diffuse erythematous maculopapular exanthems,** which may evolve into **vesicle formation** and subsequent **desquamation**.